

Bencik Wins Batboy Contest

Cathedral Youth Unanimous Pick

John Bencik Jr., 16, a Cathedral High School junior, is winner of The Indianapolis Star's 1957 Batboy Contest held in cooperation with Indians, Inc.

Bencik starts to work tonight at Victory Field when he'll lug the lumber for the Minneapolis Millers, opponents of the Indians in the season-opener.

The 5-foot, 7-inch 143-pounder, who'll patrol right field for the Irish nine this season, was selected winner following an interview of each of the 10 finalists.

VALDIS CAUNE, 15-year-old Shortridge High School freshman, was selected first alternate and Darrell Laird, 13, an eighth grade pupil at Maywood Grade School, is second alternate.

Tribe Manager Andy Cohen, Indian's Coach Johnny Hutchings, Art Wright, Indian's publicity director, and William R. Shover of The Star public relations department selected Bencik.

Bencik, who lives at 711 North Concord Street, was first on each of the judges ballots and Caune was named runner-up unanimously.

Men Drivers Top 3 Classes In Fuel Test

San Francisco (UP)—Last year's sweepstakes winner, Mel Alsbury Jr., jumped into the lead in the Mobilgas economy run yesterday as the men served firm notice they'll be tougher to beat in the matter of economical motoring than the women figured.

Men drivers placed first in stingy gasoline consumption in three of the four automobile classifications on the first leg—Los Angeles to San Francisco—of the 1,568-mile, four-day racing test to Sun Valley, Idaho.

LONE WOMAN to take first-lap honors in the run that this year for the first time pits women drivers against the men was Mary Davis, a pretty blond West Hollywood restaurateur. She rolled up 20.5909 miles per gallon at the required minimum 40.33 miles-per-hour on the 453.7-mile trip. She was driving a Plymouth Belvedere eight.

Runnerup in the sweepstakes competition to Alsbury, who was driving an Imperial Crown, was his mother, Mrs. Mildred Alsbury, driving the identical model. Alsbury chalked up a 19.9376 miles per gallon average to his mother's 19.0523.

Other finalists, whose letters were judged tops from the more than 600 entrants, were:

Robert Asher, 12, 8381 Moore Road; David Clements, 12, 4141 North Emerson Avenue; Clark Leroy Dickerson, 12, 510 South Addison Street; Steve Jack Ent, 12, 5878 Nash Lane; Larry Sachs, 13, 760 North DeQuincy Street; Larry Ross Spear, 16, 6145 Crittenden Avenue, and Steve Walker, 13, R.R. 10, Box 297.

EACH OF THE finalists will receive a season pass to Victory Field.

Bencik is the second Cathedral winner in the history of the popular contest. Ray (Buzzy) Oyler, three-sport athlete at Cathedral, now serving in the United States Marine Corps, won the first contest in 1952. Other winners and their schools are Leland Lewis, Shortridge; Jimmy Montgomery, Lawrence Central; Bruce Schlegel, Broad Ripple; Denny Cummings, Decatur Central, and Jan Merritt of Broad Ripple, '56 winner, who will work for the Indians this season.

John is the oldest of five children. His father, John Bencik Sr., is a city fireman. His uncle, Patrolman Arthur Bencik, is police PAL Club officer at Rhodius Park.

John has participated in PAL Club sports several years and captained the teams on which he played in classes A and D.

Roger Maris was his favorite Indian last season and his all-time favorite is Rocky Colavito who thought enough of John to issue him a personal invitation to his wedding. John and Rocky still correspond.

JOHN WAS graduated from Holy Trinity Grade School and is a member of Holy Trinity parish.

At Cathedral he has a scholastic average of 75-80 percent. John would like to use the \$400 college scholarship he'll receive after next season at Purdue University. He'd like to major in engineering.

John, who says he's never won a contest before, will be honored at Batboy Night next month when the Cathedral student body and faculty will attend a game as guests of the Indianapolis management.



A TRY FOR SIZE—Trying on for size the cap he'll wear the next two summers as winner of The Indianapolis Star Batboy Contest in cooperation with the Indianapolis Indians is John Bencik Jr., a Cathedral High School junior. Indianapolis Manager Andy Cohen fits the cap on Bencik as Indians Coach Johnny Hutchings and contest runner-up Valdis Caune look on. (Star Photo by Wayne Kelly)

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